Storm

By Tim Minchin

INTRODUCTION

Being a hippie is not a matter of dress, behavior, economic or social status. It is a philosophical approach to life that emphasizes freedom, peace, love and a respect for others and the earth. The way of the hippie never died. There have always been hippies from the first time society laid down rules, to Jesus, to Henry David Thoreau, to John Lennon, to you and me. I believe there's a little hippy in all of us. It's just been repressed by our socialization process. We need to find it and cultivate our hippie within. Only then can we reach our true potential. Here is your first lesson: Memorize these quotes from great men, and use them as mantras for your life. "Give peace a chance"~ John Lennon "We must learn to live as brothers, or parish as fools"~ Martin Luther King Jr. "What shall it profit a man if he gains the whole world, but loses his soul?"~Jesus Christ

But in the meantime, let me introduce you to Storm by Tim Minchin

Inner North London, top floor flat

All white walls, white carpet, white cat,

Rice Paper partitions

Modern art and ambition

The host's a physician,

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Lovely bloke, has his own practice

His girlfriend's an actress

An old mate from home

And they're always great fun.

So to dinner we've come.

The fifth guest is an unknown,

The hosts have just thrown

Us together for a favor

because this girl's just arrived from Australia

And has moved to North London

And she's the sister of someone

Or has some connection.

As we make introductions

I'm struck by her beauty

She's irrefutably fair

With dark eyes and dark hair

But as she sits

I admit I'm a little bit wary

because I notice the tip of the wing of a fairy

Tattooed on that popular area

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Just above the derrière
And when she says "I'm Sagittarian"
I confess a pigeonhole starts to form
And is immediately filled with pigeon
When she says her name is Storm.
Chatter is initially bright and light-hearted
But it's not long before Storm gets started:
"You can't know anything,
Knowledge is merely opinion"
She opines, over her Cabernet Sauvignon
Vis-à-vis,
Some un-hippily
Empirical comment by me
"Not a good start" I think
We're only on pre-dinner drinks
And across the room, my wife
Widens her eyes
Silently begs me, Be Nice
A matrimonial warning
Not worth ignoring
So I resist the urge to ask Storm

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Whether knowledge is so loose-weave
Of a morning
When deciding whether to leave
Her apartment by the front door
Or a window on the second floor.
The food is delicious and Storm,
Whilst avoiding all meat
Happily sits and eats
While the good doctor,
Holds court on some anachronistic aspect of medical history
When Storm suddenly she insists
"But the human body is a mystery!
Science just falls in a hole
When it tries to explain the nature of the soul."
My hostess throws me a glance
She, like my wife, knows there's a chance
That I'll be off on one of my rants
But my lips are sealed.
I just want to enjoy my meal
And although Storm is starting to get my goat

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I have no intention of rocking the boat,
Although it's becoming a bit of a wrestle
Because -- like her meteorological namesake -
Storm has no such concerns for our vessel:
"Pharmaceutical companies are the enemy
They promote drug dependency
At the cost of the natural remedies
That are all our bodies need
They are immoral and driven by greed.
Why take drugs
When herbs can solve it?
Why use chemicals
When homeopathic solvents
Can resolve it?
It's time we all return-to-live
With natural medical alternatives."
And try as hard as I like,
A small crack appears
In my diplomacy-dike.
"By definition", I begin
"Alternative Medicine", I continue

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"Has either not been proved to work,
Or been proved not to work.
You know what they call "alternative medicine"
That's been proved to work?
Medicine."
"So you don't believe
In ANY Natural remedies?"
"On the contrary actually:
Before we came to tea,
I took a natural remedy
Derived from the bark of a willow tree
A painkiller that's virtually side-effect free
It's got a weird name,
Darling, what was it again?
Masprin?
Basprin?
Asprin!
Which I paid about a buck for
Down at my local drugstore.
The debate briefly abates
As our hosts collects plates

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but as they return with desserts
Storm pertly asserts,
"Shakespeare said it first:
There are more things in heaven and earth
Than exist in your philosophy…
Science is just how we're trained to look at reality,
It can't explain love or spirituality.
How does science explain psychics?
Auras; the afterlife; the power of prayer?"
I'm becoming aware
That I'm staring,
I'm like a rabbit suddenly trapped
In the blinding headlights of vacuous crap.
Maybe it's the Hamlet she just mis-quothed
Or the eighth glass of wine I just quaffed
But my diplomacy dike groans
And the arsehole held back by its stones
Can be held back no more:
"Look , Storm, I don't mean to bore you
But there's no such thing as an aura!
Reading Auras is like reading minds

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Or star-signs or tea-leaves or meridian lines
These people aren't plying a skill,
They are either lying or mentally ill.
Same goes for those who claim to hear God's demands
And Spiritual healers who think they have magic hands.
By the way,
Why is it OK
For people to pretend they can talk to the dead?
Is it not totally fucked in the head
Lying to some crying woman whose child has died
And telling her you're in touch with the other side?
That's just fundamentally sick
Do we need to clarify that there's no such thing as a psychic?
What, are we fucking 2?
Do we actually think that Horton Heard a Who?
Do we still think that Santa brings us gifts?
That Michael Jackson hasn't had facelifts?
Are we still so stunned by circus tricks
That we think that the dead would

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Wanna talk to pricks
Like John Edward?
Storm to her credit despite my derision
Keeps firing off clichés with startling precision
Like a sniper using bollocks for ammunition
"You're so sure of your position
But you're just closed-minded
I think you'll find
Your faith in Science and Tests
Is just as blind
As the faith of any fundamentalist"
"Hm that's a good point, let me think for a bit
Oh wait, my mistake.
Science adjusts its beliefs based on what's observed
Faith is the denial of observation so that Belief can be preserved.
If you show me
That, say, homeopathy works,
Then I will change my mind
I'll spin on a dime
I'll be embarrassed as hell,

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But I will run through the streets yelling
It's a miracle! Take physics and bin it!
Water has memory!
And while it's memory of a long lost drop of onion juice is Infinite
It somehow forgets all the poo it's had in it!
You show me that it works and how it works
And when I've recovered from the shock
I will take a compass and carve Fancy That on the side of my cock."
Everyone's just staring at me now,
But I'm pretty pissed and I've dug this far down,
So I figure, in for penny, in for a pound:
"Life is full of mysteries, yeah,
But there are answers out there
And they won't be found
By people sitting around
Looking serious
And saying isn't life mysterious?
Let's sit here and hope
Let's call up the Pope

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Let's go watch Oprah
Interview Deepak Chopra
If you're going to watch tele, you should watch Scooby
Doo.
That show was so cool
because every time there's a church with a ghoul
Or a ghost in a school
They looked beneath the mask and what was inside?
The janitor or the dude who runs the water-slide.
Throughout history
Every mystery
EVER solved has turned out to be
Not Magic.
Does the idea that there might be truth
Frighten you?
Does the idea that one afternoon
On Wikipedia might enlighten you
Frighten you?
Does the notion that there may not be a supernatural
So blow your hippy noodle

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That you would rather just stand in the fog
Of your inability to Google?
Isn't this enough?
Just this world?
Just this beautiful, complex
Wonderfully unfathomable world?
How does it so fail to hold our attention
That we have to diminish it with the invention
Of cheap, man-made Myths and Monsters?
If you're so into Shakespeare
Lend me your ear:
"To gild refined gold, to paint the lily,
To throw perfume on the violet… is just silly"
Or something like that.
Or what about Satchmo?!
I see trees of Green,
Red roses too,
And fine, if you wish to
Glorify Krishna and Vishnu
In a post-colonial, condescending
Bottled-up and labeled kind of way

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That's ok.

I am a tiny, insignificant, ignorant lump of carbon.

I have one life, and it is short

And unimportant…

But thanks to recent scientific advances

I get to live twice as long as my great great great great

uncles and auntses.

Twice as long to live this life of mine

Twice as long to love this wife of mine

Twice as many years of friends and wine

Of sharing curries and getting shitty

With good-looking hippies

With fairies on their spines

And if perchance I have offended

Think but this and all is mended:

We'd as well be 10 minutes back in time,

For all the chance you'll change your mind.

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SOURCE INFORMATION

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